

Category 2 ambulance response

Outturn for September 2026 · forecast issued with data through August 2026

The published result was 31.3 min. It was 0.4 min worse than outlook · inside the 80% range. The provider distribution and trajectory watch have been refreshed using the new release.

LATEST • AUGUST 2026

28.9 min

No archived pre-release forecast

OUTLOOK • SEPTEMBER 2026

30.9 min

80% range 24.2 min–36.1 min

ACTUAL

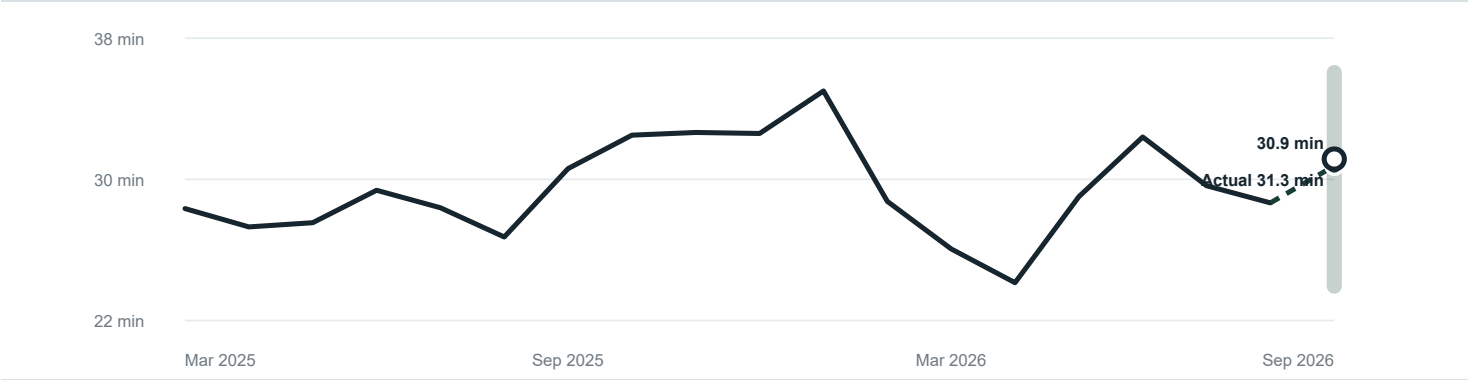
31.3 min

0.4 min worse than outlook · inside the 80% range

Off course · 25 minutes during 2026/27

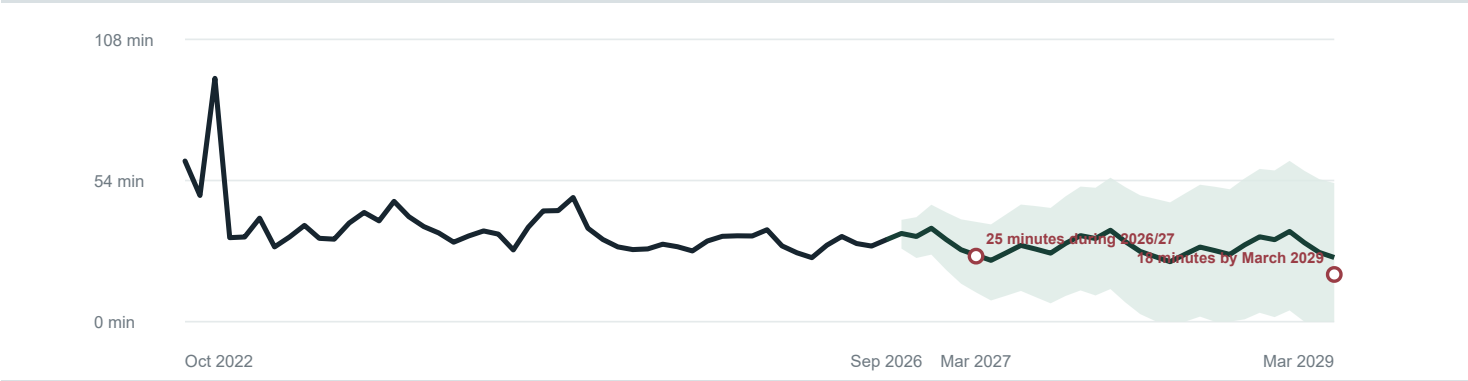
Recent performance and current release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



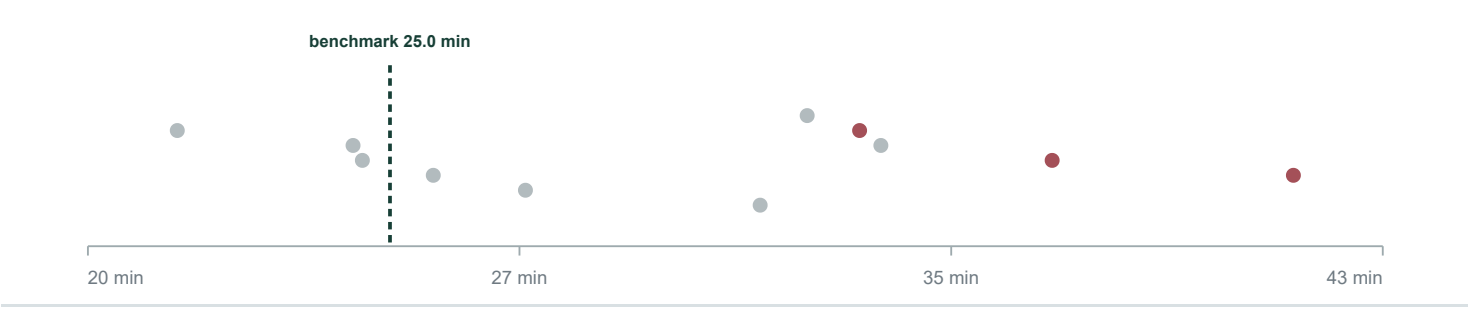
Benchmark: 18-minute standard, 1.1 min above milestone
Data: NHS England Ambulance Quality Indicators. **Targets:** Medium Term Planning Framework interim target · Medium Term Planning Framework final target
Method: Backtest-weighted ensemble of current-level seasonal movement, damped annual drift and a damped recent seasonal trend; at least 2 components are required. The final fit uses 110 consecutive months. Accuracy is tested on 36 rolling one-month-ahead forecasts. The 80% range uses empirical historical error quantiles from 36 forecast errors. Weights use inverse rolling RMSE and are shrunk toward equal weights. The pre-release commentary compares the current-level seasonal component with the combined forecast. Provider distribution and trajectory watch are shown on page 2.

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Distribution and trajectory watch · August 2026

Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.



Trajectory watch

Signals show sustained departures from each provider's own archived outlook. A low performer can be improving, and a high performer can be deteriorating. Status: Actual performance is compared with the monthly path forecast six months earlier. The displayed figure is the average gap across those six months.

11 providers assessed	0 sustained favourable	3 sustained adverse	8 without an active signal						
Largest sustained favourable moves No qualifying signal.		Largest sustained adverse moves <table><tr><td>SOUTH WESTERN AMBULANCE SERVICE NHS FOUNDATION TRUST Latest 37.0 min · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest</td><td>9.9 min AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH</td></tr><tr><td>LONDON AMBULANCE SERVICE NHS TRUST Latest 33.5 min · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest</td><td>5.0 min AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH</td></tr><tr><td>EAST OF ENGLAND AMBULANCE SERVICE NHS TRUST Latest 41.4 min · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest</td><td>3.4 min AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH</td></tr></table>		SOUTH WESTERN AMBULANCE SERVICE NHS FOUNDATION TRUST Latest 37.0 min · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	9.9 min AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH	LONDON AMBULANCE SERVICE NHS TRUST Latest 33.5 min · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	5.0 min AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH	EAST OF ENGLAND AMBULANCE SERVICE NHS TRUST Latest 41.4 min · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	3.4 min AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH
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Trajectory-watch rule. Six actual months are compared with the corresponding path fixed before the six-month window. A signal requires a material average gap, at least five of six months in the same direction, and the latest month confirming that direction. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality.